9, 1985 adopting a set of guidelines for consumer protection to persuade the member countries to adopt policies and laws for better protection of the interests of the consumers. The guidelines provided that the governments should develop or maintain a strong consumer protection policy, taking into account the guidelines.

Objectives of United Nations Guidelines for Consumer Protection

i. To assist countries in achieving or maintaining adequate protection for their population as consumers

ii. To facilitate production and distribution patterns responsive to the needs and desires of consumers

iii. To encourage high levels of ethical conduct for those engaged in the production and distribution of goods and services to consumers

iv. To assist countries in curbing abusive business practices by all enterprises at the national and international levels which adversely affect consumers

v. To facilitate the developing of independent consumer groups

vi. To further international co-operation in the field of consumer protection

vii. To encourage the development of market conditions which provide consumers with greater choice at lower prices.

16.08 Consumer Legislation

i. **The Indian Contract Act, 1872** was passed to bind the people on the promise made in the contract.

ii. **The Sale of Goods Act, 1930** This Act protects consumers against sellers not complying with expressed and implied warranties in the sale contract.

iii. **The Essential Commodities Act, 1955** protects the consumers against artificial shortages created by the sellers by hoarding the goods and thus selling the goods at high prices in black market in respect of essential commodities.

iv. **The Agricultural Products Grading and Marketing Act, 1937** ensures the supply of agricultural commodities at high quality.

v. **The Prevention of Food Adulteration Act, 1954** checks the adulteration of food articles and ensures purity of goods supplied and thus protects the health of consumers.

vi. **Weights and Measures Act, 1976** protects the consumer against malpractices of underweight or under measurement. This Act has been replaced as the Legal Metrology Act, 2009.

vii. **The Trademark Act, 1999** prevents the use of fraudulent marks on the product.

viii. **The Competition Act, 2002** protects the consumers against unhealthy competition.

ix. **Indian Standard Institution (Certification marks) Act, 1952** (Now ISI is known as Bureau of Indian Standards) provides special marks to products fulfilling minimum quality standards and thus ensures supply of quality products to consumers.

x. **The Drugs and Magic Remedies (advertisements) Act, 1954** prohibits advertisement of drugs and remedies claiming to have magical properties.

xi. **The Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940** ensures the safety of drugs and cosmetics sold in India.

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